

Oaths

The lawful purpose of, explained.

Hebrews 6:16 For men verily swear by the greater: and an Oath for confirmation is to them an end of all strife.

Antiquity of.

Genesis 14:22 And Abram said to the king of Sodom, I have lift up mine hand unto the LORD, the most high God, the possessor of heaven and earth,

Genesis 24:3 And I will make thee swear by the LORD, the God of heaven, and the God of the earth, that thou shalt not take a wife unto my son of the daughters of the Canaanites, among whom I dwell:

Genesis 24:8 And if the woman will not be willing to follow thee, then thou shalt be clear from this my Oath: only bring not my son thither again.

USED FOR

Confirming covenants.

Genesis 26:28 And they said, We saw certainly that the LORD was with thee: and we said, Let there be now an Oath Betwixt us, even Betwixt us and thee, and let us make a covenant with thee;

Genesis 31:44 Now therefore come thou, let us make a covenant, I and thou; and let it be for a Witness between me and thee.

Genesis 31:53 The God of Abraham, and the God of Nahor, the God of their Father, Judge Betwixt us. And Jacob sware by the fear of his Father Isaac.

1 Samuel 20:16-17 So Jonathan made a covenant with the house of David, saying, Let the LORD even require it at the hand of David's enemies. 17 And Jonathan caused David to swear again, because he loved him: for he loved him as he loved his own soul. Deciding controversies in courts of law.

Exodus 22:11 Then shall an Oath of the LORD be between them both, that he hath not put his hand unto his neighbour's goods; and the owner of it shall accept thereof, and he shall not make it good.

Numbers 5:19 And the priest shall charge her by an Oath, and say unto the woman, If no man have lain with thee, and if thou hast not gone aside to uncleanness with another instead of thy husband, be thou free from this bitter water that causeth the curse:

1 Kings 8:31 If any man trespass against his neighbour, and an Oath be laid upon him to cause him to swear, and the Oath come before thine altar in this house:
Pledging allegiance to sovereigns.

2 Kings 11:4 And the seventh year Jehoiada sent and fetched the rulers over hundreds, with the Captains and the guard, and brought them to him into the house of the LORD, and made a covenant with them, and took an Oath of them in the house of the LORD, and shewed them the king's son.

Ecclesiastes 8:2 I counsel thee to keep the king's commandment, and that in regard of the Oath of God.

Binding to performance of sacred duties.

Numbers 30:2 If a man vow a vow unto the LORD, or swear an Oath to bind his soul with a bond; he shall not break his word, he shall do according to all that proceedeth out of his mouth.

2 Chronicles 15:14-15 And they swore unto the LORD with a loud voice, and with shouting, and with trumpets, and with cornets. 15 And all Judah rejoiced at the Oath: for they had sworn with all their heart, and sought him with their whole desire; and he was found of them: and the LORD gave them rest round about.

Binding to performance of any particular act.

Genesis 24:3 And I will make thee swear by the LORD, the God of heaven, and the God of the earth, that thou shalt not take a wife unto my son of the daughters of the Canaanites, among whom I dwell:

Genesis 50:25 And Joseph took an Oath of the children of Israel, saying, God will surely visit you, and ye shall carry up my bones from hence.

Joshua 2:12 Now therefore, I pray you, swear unto me by the LORD, since I have shewed you kindness, that ye will also shew kindness unto my Father's house, and give me a true token:

Judicial from of administering.

1 Kings 22:16 And the king said unto him, How many times shall I Adjure thee that thou tell me nothing but that which is true in the name of the LORD?

Matthew 26:63 But Jesus held his peace. And the High Priest answered and said unto him, I Adjure thee by the living God, that thou tell us whether thou be the Christ, the Son of God.

Often accompanied by raising up the hand.

Genesis 14:22 And Abram said to the king of Sodom, I have lift up mine hand unto the LORD, the most high God, the possessor of heaven and earth,

Daniel 12:7 And I heard the man clothed in linen, which was upon the waters of the river, when he held up his right hand and his left hand unto heaven, and sware by him that liveth for ever that it shall be for a time, times, and an half; and when he shall have accomplished to scatter the power of the holy people, all these things shall be finished.

Revelation 10:5-6 And the angel which I saw stand upon the sea and upon the earth lifted up his hand to heaven, 6 And sware by him that liveth for ever and ever, who created heaven, and the things that therein are, and the earth, and the things that therein are, and the sea, and the things which are therein, that there should be time no longer:

Often accompanied by placing the hand under the thigh of the person sworn to.

Genesis 24:2 And Abraham said unto his eldest Servant of his house, that ruled over all that he had, Put, I pray thee, thy hand under my thigh:

Genesis 47:29 And the time drew nigh that Israel must die: and he called his son Joseph, and said unto him, If now I have found grace in thy sight, put, I pray thee, thy hand under my thigh, and deal kindly and truly with me; bury me not, I pray thee, in Egypt:

To be taken in fear and reverence.

Ecclesiastes 9:2 All things come alike to all: there is one event to the Righteous, and to the wicked; to the good and to the clean, and to the unclean; to him that sacrificeth, and to him that sacrificeth not: as is the good, so is the sinner; and he that sweareth, as he that feareth an Oath.

THE JEWS

Forbidden to take, in name of Idols.

Joshua 23:7 That ye come not among these nations, these that remain among you; neither make mention of the name of their gods, nor cause to swear by them, neither serve them, nor bow yourselves unto them:

Forbidden to take in the name of any created thing.

Matthew 5:34-36 But I say unto you, Swear not at all; neither by heaven; for it is God's throne: 35 Nor by the earth; for it is his footstool: neither by Jerusalem; for it is the city of the great King. 36 Neither shalt thou swear by thy head, because thou canst not make one hair white or black.

James 5:12 But above all things, my Brethren, swear not, neither by heaven, neither by the earth, neither by any other Oath: but let your yea be yea; and your nay, nay; lest ye fall into condemnation.

Forbidden to take false.

Leviticus 6:3 Or have found that which was lost, and lieth concerning it, and sweareth falsely; in any of all these that a man doeth, sinning therein:

Zechariah 8:17 And let none of you imagine evil in your hearts against his neighbour; and love no false Oath: for all these are things that I hate, saith the LORD.

Forbidden to take rash, or unholy.

Leviticus 5:4 Or if a soul swear, pronouncing with his lips to do evil, or to do good, whatsoever it be that a man shall pronounce with an Oath, and it be hid from him; when he knoweth of it, then he shall be guilty in one of these.

To use God's name alone in.

Deuteronomy 6:13 Thou shalt fear the LORD thy God, and serve him, and shalt swear by his name.

Deuteronomy 10:20 Thou shalt fear the LORD thy God; him shalt thou serve, and to

him shalt thou Cleave, and swear by his name.

Isaiah 65:16 That he who blesseth himself in the earth shall bless himself in the God of truth; and he that sweareth in the earth shall swear by the God of truth; because the former troubles are forgotten, and because they are hid from mine eyes.

To take, in truth, Judgment, ect.

Jeremiah 4:2 And thou shalt swear, The LORD liveth, in truth, in Judgment, and in righteousness; and the nations shall bless themselves in him, and in him shall they glory.

Generally respected the obligation of.

Joshua 9:19-20 But all the Princes said unto all the Congregation, We have sworn unto them by the LORD God of Israel: now therefore we may not touch them. 20 This we will do to them; we will even let them live, lest wrath be upon us, because of the Oath which we swore unto them.

2 Samuel 21:7 But the king spared Mephibosheth, the son of Jonathan the son of Saul, because of the LORDS' Oath that was between them, between David and Jonathan the son of Saul.

Psalms 15:4 In whose eyes a vile person is contemned; but he honoureth them that fear the LORD. He that sweareth to his own hurt, and changeth not.

Matthew 14:9 And the king was sorry: nevertheless for the Oath's sake, and them which sat with him at meat, he commanded it to be given her.

Fell into many errors respecting.

Matthew 23:16-22 Woe unto you, ye blind guides, which say, Whosoever shall swear by the temple, it is nothing; but whosoever shall swear by the gold of the temple, he is a debtor! 17 Ye fools and blind: for whether is greater, the gold, or the temple that sanctifieth the gold? 18 And, Whosoever shall swear by the altar, it is nothing; but whosoever sweareth by the gift that is upon it, he is guilty. 19 Ye fools and blind: for whether is greater, the gift, or the altar that sanctifieth the gift? ...

Often guilty of rashly taking.

Judges 21:7 How shall we do for wives for them that remain, seeing we have sworn by the LORD that we will not give them of our daughters to wives?

Matthew 14:7 Whereupon he promised with an Oath to give her whatsoever she would ask.

Matthew 26:72 And again he denied with an Oath, I do not know the man.

Often guilty of falsely taking.

Leviticus 6:3 Or have found that which was lost, and lieth concerning it, and sweareth falsely; in any of all these that a man doeth, sinning therein:

Jeremiah 5:2 And though they say, The LORD liveth; surely they swear falsely.

Jeremiah 7:9 Will ye steal, murder, and commit adultery, and swear falsely, and burn incense unto Baal, and walk after other gods whom ye know not; Condemned for false.

Zechariah 5:4 I will bring it forth, saith the LORD of hosts, and it shall enter into the house of the Thief, and into the house of him that sweareth falsely by my name: and it shall remain in the midst of his house, and shall consume it with the timber thereof and the stones thereof.

Malachi 3:5 And I will come near to you to Judgment; and I will be a swift Witness against the sorcerers, and against the adulterers, and against false swearers, and against those that oppress the hireling in his wages, the widow, and the Fatherless, and that turn aside the stranger from his right, and fear not me, saith the LORD of hosts.

Condemned for profane.

Jeremiah 23:10 For the land is full of adulterers; for because of swearing the land mourneth; the pleasant places of the wilderness are dried up, and their course is evil, and their force is not right.

Hosea 4:2 By swearing, and lying, and killing, and stealing, and committing adultery, they break out, and blood toucheth blood.

INSTANCES OF RASH, ect.;

Joshua, ect.

Joshua 9:15-16 And Joshua made peace with them, and made a league with them, to let them live: and the Princes of the Congregation swore unto them. 16 And it came to pass at the end of three days after they had made a league with them, that they heard that they were their neighbours, and that they dwelt among them.

Jephthah.

Judges 11:30-36 And Jephthah vowed a vow unto the LORD, and said, If thou shalt without fail deliver the children of Ammon into mine hands, 31 Then it shall be, that whatsoever cometh forth of the doors of my house to meet me, when I return in peace from the children of Ammon, shall surely be the LORDS', and I will offer it up for a Burnt Offering. 32 So Jephthah passed over unto the children of Ammon to fight against them; and the LORD delivered them into his hands. 33 And he smote them from Aroer, even till thou come to Minnith, even twenty cities, and unto the plain of the vineyards, with a very great slaughter. Thus the children of Ammon were subdued before the children of Israel. ...

Saul.

1 Samuel 14:27 But Jonathan heard not when his Father charged the people with the Oath: wherefore he put forth the end of the rod that was in his hand, and dipped it in an honeycomb, and put his hand to his mouth; and his eyes were enlightened.

1 Samuel 14:44 And Saul answered, God do so and more also: for thou shalt surely die, Jonathan.

Herod.

Matthew 14:7-9 Whereupon he promised with an Oath to give her whatsoever she would ask. 8 And she, being before instructed of her mother, said, Give me here John Baptist's head in a Charger. 9 And the king was sorry: nevertheless for the Oath's sake, and them which sat with him at meat, he commanded it to be given her.

The Jews who sought to kill Paul.

Acts 23:21 But do not thou yield unto them: for there lie in wait for him of them more than forty men, which have bound themselves with an Oath, that they will neither eat nor drink till they have killed him: and now are they ready, looking for a promise from thee.

Custom of swearing by the life of the king.

Genesis 42:15-16 Hereby ye shall be proved: By the life of Pharaoh ye shall not go forth hence, except your youngest brother come hither. 16 Send one of you, and let him fetch your brother, and ye shall be kept in prison, that your words may be proved, whether there be any truth in you: or else by the life of Pharaoh surely ye are spies.

EXPRESSIONS USED AS;

By the fear of Isaac.

Genesis 31:53 The God of Abraham, and the God of Nahor, the God of their Father, Judge Betwixt us. And Jacob swore by the fear of his Father Isaac.

As the Lord liveth.

Judges 8:19 And he said, They were my Brethren, even the sons of my mother: as the

LORD liveth, if ye had saved them alive, I would not slay you.

Ruth 3:13 Tarry this night, and it shall be in the morning, that if he will perform unto thee the part of a kinsman, well; let him do the kinsman's part: but if he will not do the part of a kinsman to thee, then will I do the part of a kinsman to thee, as the LORD liveth: lie down until the morning.

The Lord do so to me, and more also.

Ruth 1:17 Where thou diest, will I die, and there will I be buried: the LORD do so to me, and more also, if ought but Death part thee and me.

God do so to thee, and more also.

1 Samuel 3:17 And he said, What is the thing that the LORD hath said unto thee? I pray thee hide it not from me: God do so to thee, and more also, if thou hide any thing from me of all the things that he said unto thee.

By the Lord.

2 Samuel 19:7 Now therefore arise, go forth, and speak comfortably unto thy servants: for I swear by the LORD, if thou go not forth, there will not tarry one with thee this night: and that will be worse unto thee than all the evil that befell thee from thy youth until now.

1 Kings 2:42 And the king sent and called for Shimei, and said unto him, Did I not make thee to swear by the LORD, and protested unto thee, saying, Know for a certain, on the day thou goest out, and walkest abroad any whither, that thou shalt surely die? and thou saidst unto me, The word that I have heard is good.

Before God I lie not.

Galatians 1:20 Now the things which I write unto you, behold, before God, I lie not.

I call God for a record.

2 Corinthians 1:23 Moreover I call God for a record upon my soul, that to spare you I came not as yet unto Corinth.

God is Witness.

1 Thessalonians 2:5 For neither at any time used we flattering words, as ye know, nor a cloke of covetousness; God is Witness:

I charge you by the Lord.

1 Thessalonians 5:27 I charge you by the Lord that this epistle be read unto all the holy Brethren.

As thy soul liveth.

1 Samuel 1:26 And she said, Oh my lord, as thy soul liveth, my lord, I am the woman that stood by thee here, praying unto the LORD.

1 Samuel 25:26 Now therefore, my lord, as the LORD liveth, and as thy soul liveth, seeing the LORD hath withholden thee from coming to shed blood, and from avenging thyself with thine own hand, now let thine enemies, and they that seek evil to my lord, be as Nabal.

God used, to show the immutability of His counsel.

Genesis 22:16 And said, By myself have I sworn, saith the LORD, for because thou hast done this thing, and hast not withheld thy son, thine only son:

Numbers 14:28 Say unto them, As truly as I live, saith the LORD, as ye have spoken in mine ears, so will I do to you:

Hebrews 6:17 Wherein God, willing more abundantly to shew unto the heirs of promise the immutability of his counsel, confirmed it by an Oath: